

CHAPTER 3: AREA AB — THE POOLS COMPLEX

using the Pavilion were able to view the activities in and around the two swimming pools. (Further to the north, beyond the pools, they could observe the surrounding landscape above the closed Hasmonean Garden, while on the west, part of the view was blocked by the palace building.) It was not by chance that when the Twin Palaces were built in Stage 5, it was decided to integrate these two mansions into the slope in order not to block the splendid view from the Pavilion.

The various units in Area AB, with reference to the stages which existed in each of them, will be described in the following order:

- The two Swimming Pools [A(B)101];
- the Plaza — the paved area around the two pools, including a discussion of the water systems connected with the Pools Complex;
- the Pavilion [A(B)103], including the surrounding gardens;
- the Western Garden together with the bathing installations exposed in it;
- the Eastern Garden together with the storerooms revealed here;
- the Hasmonean Garden — a peristyle garden.



Ill. 103. Pools A(B)101, viewed from the north.



Ill. 104. Longitudinal section through Pools A(B)101, viewed from the east.
Section through Sounding A(B)23, viewed from the north.

THE TWO SWIMMING POOLS A(B)101 (later combined into one; see Plan 14 and Ills. 103, 104)

As mentioned above, even prior to our excavations, the remains of a large pool (ca. 32×18 m) were clearly visible in the area to the northeast of the Northern Tell (see Ill. 101). All of the pool's sidewalls, apart from the eastern one, were preserved almost to their original height. Along the pool's southern edge, even a section of the initial plaster coating has survived over a length of ca. 3 m, together with the adjacent Plaza floor. Part of this plaster coating also curved downward, over the rim of the pool, covering a strip 40 cm in height, apparently the remains of a bench (see below).

Over the years the pool had been filled with debris to a height of ca. 1.5 m (ca. 2 m below its top), but neither the original steps nor the central podium (which was created when the two original pools were combined into one) were visible (see Ill. 105).

Our study of the pool commenced with a series of soundings. Later, when the general layout was sufficiently clear, mechanical equipment was used in order to remove much of the above-mentioned

debris, leaving the remainder (ca. 50 cm high) *in situ* on top of the floor. Only in some of the corners (and later, during restoration work, also along the walls) was the floor revealed.

An interesting feature in the general layout of the two pools is that their western walls are aligned, while the eastern walls are at a slight angle to one another. A possible explanation for this imperfect symmetry could be that, when the pools' contours were being marked on the ground, the planners started with the full western line (both pools together), while the eastern corners were marked separately, and minor errors in measurement were not corrected.

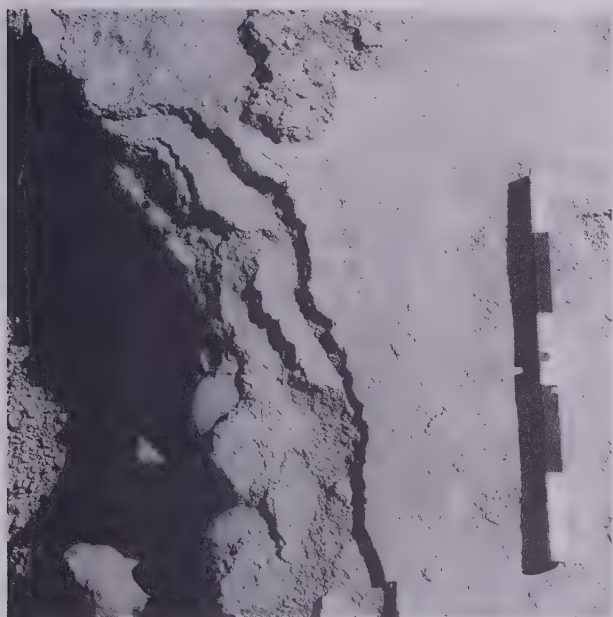
It seems that all the sidewalls of both of the initial pools were built as free-standing walls and not as revetments. Probes behind some of them [in particular A(B)23, below the western sector of the Plaza to the west of the northern pool; see Ill. 104] revealed clear foundation trenches and the straight finish of the wall's outer, concealed face. All these walls taper upward; they are 1.5 m thick at the base versus 1.2 m at the top, including the 40-cm-wide bench which was originally built into all of these sidewalls. The sole exception is the southern wall of the southern pool, which is 2.0 m thick at the bottom



Ill. 105. Strip between the two pools [A(B)101], viewed from the west.



Ill. 106. *In situ* plaster south of the southern pool, viewed from the west.



Ill. 107. Layers of plaster, detail of Ill. 106.

and 1.7 m at the top, including the bench. The walls were constructed of medium-sized fieldstones and cobblestones. (Many of the facing stones were missing but this was the result of erosion, not looting; most of them are still to be found in the debris in the pools.) The stones were set in lime mortar. The bottom of the pools and the lower parts of their sidewalls, up to ca. 1 m below the top, were coated with hydraulic ash-lime plaster. (The two pools were coated with 1 layer of ash-lime plaster applied on top of a coarse preparation layer.) The upper sections, as well as the benches built into them, and the walls' tops were coated with lime plaster (see Ills. 106, 107). Similar lime plaster was used to form the surface of the floors of the surrounding Plaza.⁴

Both pools were entered via flights of steps, 2.3 m wide. Each flight started in the southwestern corner and extended along the western sidewall (see Ills. 103, 108). However, whereas the southern flight has



Ill. 108. Flight of steps in the southern pool, viewed from the northeast.

been almost fully preserved, the upper part of the northern one was dismantled when the two pools were joined together. Most of the steps were arranged in groups of 3–4 with wider landings between them. These landings, as well as the steps, were constructed in the same manner as the sidewalls, and coated with the same ash-lime plaster.

The material finds in the pool (pools) were meager.

THE PLAZA — THE PAVED AREA AROUND THE TWO SWIMMING POOLS (including a discussion of the water systems connected with the Pools Complex)

The two large swimming pools were surrounded by a paved area (the Plaza), a sort of a large rectangular courtyard, ca. 45 m long (east-west) and 40 m wide. An extension of this paved area, ca. 15 m long (north-south) and 13 m wide, existed in the southwestern corner of the Plaza, serving as the connection with the Buried Palace.

Although remains of the Plaza's plaster floor were exposed only to the west of the two large pools, and to a certain extent also to the south, there is no doubt that there was a similar floor throughout the area of the Plaza surrounding the pools on all four sides (see above). This assumption is based primarily on the symmetry and architectural logic underlying the plan, as well as the artificial fill that was dumped on the surface existing prior to Stage 3, mainly to the east of the pools. This fill, no doubt, was part of the overall planning.

The plastered areas were basically horizontal but they undoubtedly featured gradients suitable for draining both rainwater and water splashed by the bathers as they swam or engaged in games. In any event, it is no longer possible to determine whether the drainage was entirely directed to the two pools, as was actually the case on the western side, or whether part of it was led off to the surrounding gardens. Support for the latter alternative is to be found in the small plastered areas, gutters of sorts, uncovered against the eastern face of wall W291 in the Eastern Garden [see below, Loci A(B)128 and A(B)135].

From the floor sections that have been preserved on the west and south, it is possible to determine that

the floor levels were basically adapted to the maximum height of the pools' sidewalls. In any event, we assume that the planners had taken for granted that the tops of the pools' sidewalls would be at the same level as the Plaza's floor.⁵ The pools, including the benches which formed an integral part of their sidewalls, were thus located below the level of the Plaza, as was the case in all of the swimming pools exposed in the Jericho Plain, Hasmonean as well as Herodian. Apparently the bathers had the choice of either sitting on the edge of the Plaza with their feet resting on the bench (in this position only their feet were immersed) or sitting on the bench itself with their legs and the lower part of their bodies immersed. (In both cases it is assumed that the pool was filled to the top.)

Although, in reality, the paved areas functioned as one unit, in order to facilitate our discussion we shall divide the Plaza into units, mainly the western sector and the eastern sector. (The paved strips situated to the north and the south of the swimming pools will be dealt with briefly; another section of the Plaza, between the two pools, disappeared once they were joined together, in the days of Herod, to create a larger pool.)

The western sector of the Plaza

During the excavations the western sector was designated as Locus A(B)2. It also included Loci A(B)65, A(B)77 and A(B)89; in its western extension are located Loci A(B)27 and A(B)30. At a later stage of our work, soundings were dug in a few places below the floor level here, in Loci A(B)23, A(B)229, A(B)408–411 and others. In any event, the western sector is a crucial area for comprehension of developments in the Na'aran Conduit as well as some principal features of the Pools Complex.

The discussed sector was bounded on the east by the two pools; on the north by wall W257, the southern wall of the Hasmonean Garden; on the west partly by the Western Garden, partly by wall W325 (most of which was destroyed by the moat), and partly by the Buried Palace; and on the south by wall W247. This latter wall, 75 cm thick, abuts wall W42, the easternmost wall of the Buried Palace, and runs in a straight line eastwards for a length of 17.5 m.

Some 3 m west of the 'stairway' to the Pavilion [A(B)103, see below], the wall disappears. However, in this latter section, the plaster floor of the Plaza ends in a straight line, thus suggesting that the same wall continued up to the 'stairway.' It remains an open question whether this wall was free standing or a low terrace wall for the Plaza on this side.

Large sections of a white lime plaster floor were uncovered throughout the western sector; they are better preserved in its southern half. The floor was laid on a bedding of small stones, many of which were wadi pebbles. In some parts, mainly at the center of the Plaza, two or three layers of plaster were observed.

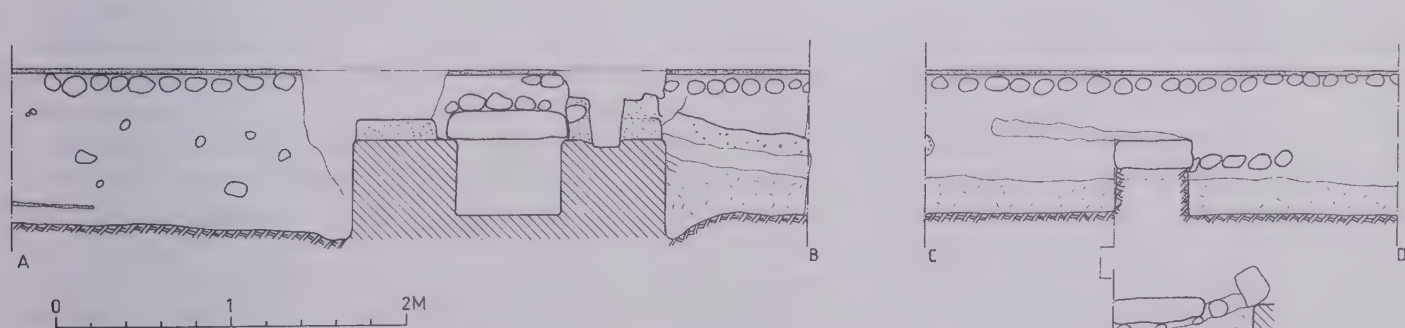
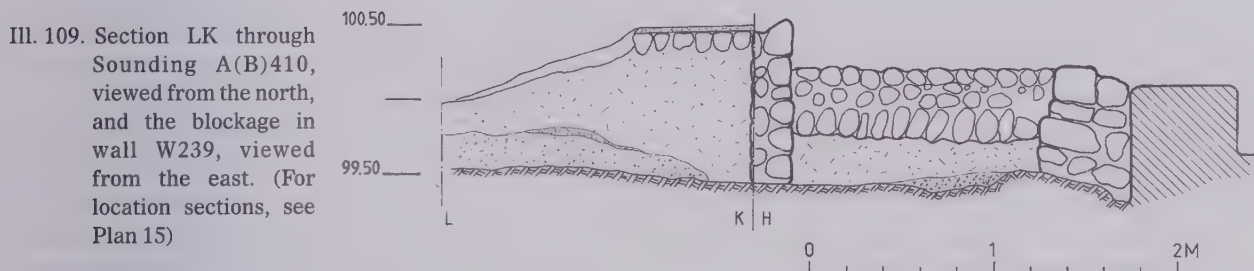
The western sector was leveled during the construction of the Pools Complex. Prior to this operation the terrain had sloped from southwest to northeast. Theoretically, part of the original surface on the south might have been lowered at that time. In the northern half, a massive fill was needed. [In Sounding A(B)23, adjacent to the northern pool, the fill below the Plaza's floor was 1.70 m deep.]

We shall deal with this sector of the Plaza under two subheadings:

- The floor and the remains under it;
- Later remains above the floor.

The floor and the remains under it (see Plan 15)

Below the level of the plaster floor, in Soundings A(B)408 and A(B)410, two walls forming a right angle — W239 running north-south, and W754 running east-west — were exposed. We would like at this point to pay attention to the relationship between the above-mentioned wall W239 and main water conduit (the southern branch of the Na'aran Conduit). The northern end of W239 abuts the plaster on the southern face of the main conduit, thus suggesting the wall was built slightly later than the conduit, and a doorway 1.3 m wide was revealed just 50 cm south of the conduit (see Ill. 109). This doorway was found blocked with small stones. However, the bottom of the blockage was slightly higher than the living surface which is associated with the wall. The blockage was also partially integrated with the doorway's northern jamb. In order to locate the tentative continuation of wall W239 north of the conduit, Trench A(B)411 (2.8 m long in an east-west direction and 80 cm wide; see Ill. 110) was dug. At the bottom of this trench a small foundation trench,



Ill. 110. Sections through Sounding A(B)410/411. Section AB, viewed from the east; section CD, viewed from the south; section EG, viewed from the west. (For location sections, see Plan 15)

adjacent to the conduit, was discernible. All the rest of the fill between the original surface and the Plaza's floor was composed of different layers with various colors and textures, and a single flat, square stone, attached to the northern side of the conduit, lay on top of the fill, in line with wall W239. However, no continuation of wall W239 was found north of the conduit.⁶

Aside from a living surface on top of which wall W239 was built, no floor existed east of this wall. On the other hand, patches of white plaster were found to its west, in the "room" which existed here between the conduit and the wall. Similar patches of plaster were also exposed to the west of the conduit, up to wall W271 at the western edge of the Plaza. In our view, these patches of white plaster, which differed from the typical plaster floors elsewhere, were probably remnants left at the work-site where the large quantities of plaster necessary for the Pools Complex were prepared. Our assumption is that the area here served as a temporary builders' shed, with its northern wall built on top of the conduit's southern wall and later dismantled. The above-mentioned doorway was part of this shed and it was blocked at the stage when the walls were demolished (leaving only their lower parts below the Plaza's floor) and the fill was laid as a bedding for the Plaza.

Apart from the above-described two walls and adjacent floor patches, all the other remains exposed below the Plaza's floor belong to the water systems of the area under discussion.

Two aspects should be taken into consideration concerning the supply of water to the two swimming pools, A(B)101. One of them is linked with the water supply to the pools themselves, a prerequisite for their operation. The other is connected with the course of the main water conduit through the Pools Complex. In any event, we consider both of these aspects to be integrally interlinked. The pools were positioned in such a way that the conduit would pass close to them, thus enabling a water supply as direct as possible. During the initial stage of our work, when we still regarded Pools A(B)101 as a single pool, we were convinced that the conduit entered the pool from the west (see Ill. 111)⁷ and exited from it on the east. On the other hand, the conduit, the course of which in all other localities was determined solely according to engineering and agricultural criteria,

had to be adapted to the planning of the complex, which had a distinctive architectural character. During the first stage of our work we attempted to examine the likelihood of the conduit having been constructed before the Pools Complex, but found no evidence of this. In any event, we have no doubt that both the Na'aran Conduit and the Pools Complex were planned and executed at the same time.

The course of the conduit within the area of the Pools Complex indicates careful thought and planning. It made its approach from the west in a straight line extending for 250 m. At its point of entry into the area of the Pools Complex, it underwent a slight change of direction (by a few degrees) and continued eastward up to point ca. 7.4 m west of the southern pool. Here it turned ca. 90° to the north and after 6.8 m reverted to its eastern course, again turning ca. 90°. The latter turn made it possible to build the continuation of the conduit close to the southern wall of the northern pool. (Although the entire above-described section of the conduit has been missing ever since the time when the pools were combined in the days of Herod, it can be reconstructed with precision on the basis of the surviving sections on either side.) In any event, although it could have been possible to lead the conduit midway between the two pools, its attachment to the southern sidewall of the northern pool was apparently intended to prevent subsidence of the conduit which was here laid on fill. Near the southeastern corner of this pool the conduit turned slightly to the north (by a few degrees), continuing eastward for ca. 13 m up to the edge of the Plaza's eastern sector. Immediately beyond this point it took a ca. 90° turn southward. It is important to mention that although the conduit, throughout the area of the Plaza, was built with the minimum gradient necessary to ensure the flow of water, it was constructed close to the level of the plaster surface, apparently in order to facilitate repairs when necessary. For this reason, in considerable parts of the area under discussion, it was laid on fill, a usually undesirable situation in the case of conduits, since any subsidence of the conduit could cause cracks and the seepage of water with all the attendant damage. In any event, it seems that easy access to the conduit in order to carry out repairs took precedence over prevention of cracks as the result of subsidence.



Ill. 111. Truncated section of the Na'aran Conduit to the west of the two swimming pools, viewed from the east.

From the last-mentioned right-angled turn, the conduit continued for another ca. 10 m along wall W331 bounding the Plaza on the east. However, in contrast to its above-described relatively horizontal course, here it was already beyond the paved area and the slope was much steeper. This steep slope actually extended up to the point where the conduit was once again built on the natural ground level. The conduit again turned eastward, this time in a straight line for a distance of ca. 240 m, up to the Industrial Area (Zone F, see Plan 1).⁸

Having dealt with the course of the conduit within the area of the Pools Complex, we return to the problem of supplying water to the two large pools. The bottom of the conduit was at a level of ca. +100.10 at the western edge of the Plaza, but at ca. +99.50 close to the swimming pools — a gradient of

about 3%. In any event, below the Plaza the conduit was covered by stone slabs above which were laid the bedding and the plaster floor. Only one group of four of these slabs was left intact, in the section 4.2–5.5 m west of the pools (see Ill. 112). The level of the top of the two pools was ca. +100.40. The structure of the pools (see above) points to a desired maximal water level of +100.10–100.20. In order to feed water from the Na'aran Conduit directly into these pools, the level of the conduit's bottom should have been at least equal to (if not higher than) the desired water level inside the pools, i.e. ca. 60 cm higher than it was built. On the other hand, the actual level of the conduit was, no doubt, dependent on the Plaza's floor, which was either equal to or slightly lower than that of the top of the pools' sidewalls. (The height of the conduit itself was ca. 40–50 cm and the additional



Ill. 112. Section of the Na'aran Conduit with its original covering, viewed from the southwest. Note the channel emerging northward in order to feed the northern swimming pool.

height for the overlying stone slabs and the plastered floor was ca. 20–25 cm.) In any event, our basic assumption, as mentioned above, is that from the outset the planners of the Pools Complex intended to surround the pools with a Plaza level with the top of the pools sidewalls.

In our humble opinion, the planners of the Pools Complex did not anticipate the difficulties involved

in leading water into these pools, which evidently came to light only in the course of the building operations.⁹ We assume that during the planning stage it was taken for granted, by the Hasmonean engineers, that once the conduit had passed between the two pools, it would be possible to build off-branching side channels by means of which water would be fed into them. However, when the interdependent digging, building and filling operations had actually been completed, it became evident to the architects that it was not possible to fill the pools to the desired maximum height from the main conduit in the sector between the pools. This problem was solved by drawing water from a higher and, of necessity, more westerly point so that the level of water in the pools would be at the desired height. The exact way in which this problem was solved remains an open question, but on the basis of the data available to us, it appears to be possible to reconstruct the main outlines.

This problem was apparently solved by leading the water through a secondary, minor channel, starting at a point 7.4 m west of the southern pool, where the main conduit turns northward. The bottom of the conduit here was at +100.08 and the estimated top at +100.45. The outlet of the minor channel was from the conduit's sidewall, as indicated by the shape of the plaster covering the side of the conduit (see Ill. 113). At that very point a small structure (hereafter



Ill. 113. Section of the channel on the conduit's eastern sidewall, connecting it with the platform, viewed from the east. Note the later blocking of the conduit. [E.N.]

termed the “platform”) was built, along the existing distance of 235 cm between the conduit and wall W239 (see below). The width of this platform was 130 cm in the west and 140 cm in the east (see Ill. 114). Its structure is very similar to that of the Na‘aran Conduit, if one is to judge from the plaster on both of

its free sides. Unfortunately, the top of the platform is missing. We can therefore only guess its form (see below).

Immediately to the east of the platform are the remains of a small channel which first passes through wall W239 at +100.40, then turns south for



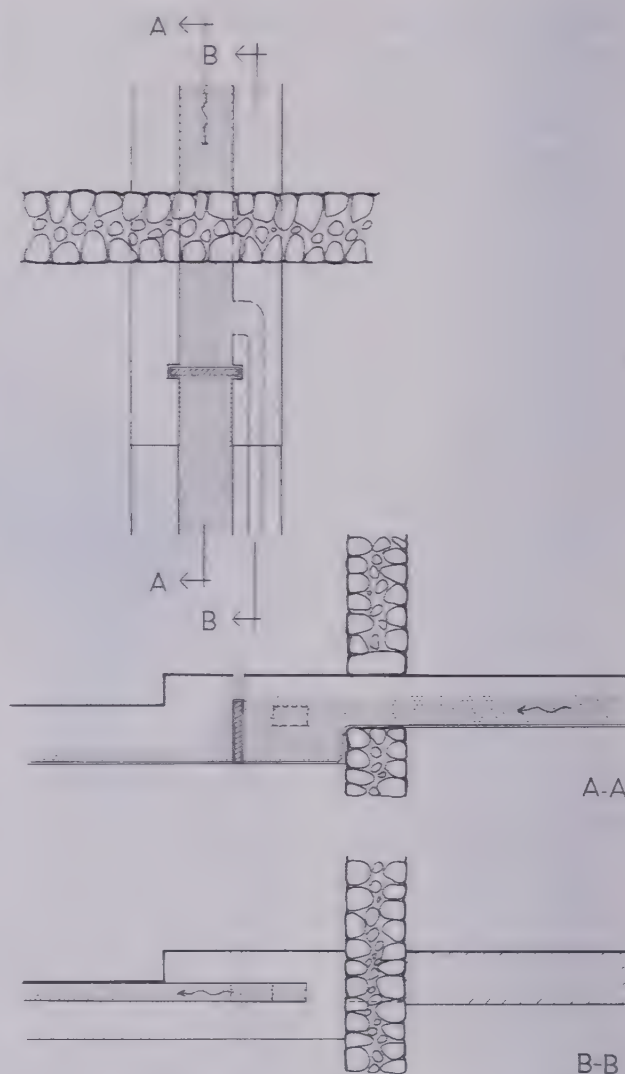
Ill. 114. Platform to the east of the Na‘aran Conduit, viewed from the east. [E.N.]

150 cm along the wall, and finally turns east (at +100.23) toward the southern swimming pool.¹⁰ No doubt, the water flowing through this small channel came from the main conduit and was led through the above-described installation (the platform). The function of this installation now comes into discussion. The only suggestion we can offer is that it functioned as a small basin, perhaps a source of drinking water for the attendants of the Pools Complex.

What remains obscure is whether the water issued from the conduit under free flow or whether a sluice was installed beyond the outlet in order to force the water into the above-mentioned secondary, minor channel. Another tentative possibility is that the conduit was covered and sealed from the point of its entry into the Pools Complex, ca. 20 m to the west of the platform. In such a case, it could have functioned as a pressure pipe but apparently such a solution was not taken into account. As a result, +100.70, the estimated level of the bottom of the conduit at its point of entry into the Pools Complex, could have been the maximum water level of the hypothetical basin on top of the platform, thus making possible a free flow of water through the platform toward the two swimming pools. In any event, we assume that at this initial stage the northern pool received its water from the southern one via a small channel laid above the Na'aran Conduit.

It appears that even the solution chosen for supplying water to the two pools, as described above, was not a perfect one. The improvement, which was probably implemented a short while later, took the form of an additional, minor channel. The new channel started further to the west, at a higher level. This time it was built directly into the northern sidewall of the main conduit. Apparently, it started at the point where the Na'aran Conduit entered the Western Garden (see below), immediately to the north of the Plaza's extension to the west. (An assumed installation is suggested by us in Ill. 115; such a simple solution might have diverted the water into the new channel.)

Along most of its length, this new minor channel followed the course of the Na'aran Conduit. Only in its last 4.5 m did it diverge from the sidewall of the main conduit and continue slightly to its north, up to the northern swimming pool (see Ill. 112). This last



Ill. 115. Proposed installation in Area AB directly west of conduit's entry into Western Garden.

improvement may have been made in Stage 4 (theoretically even during Stage 3). Only some parts of the channel are visible, as later another narrow channel, issuing from Settling Tank A(B)99, was built right on top of it.

It seems that at the same time certain changes were introduced in the main conduit itself. For some unknown reason, its sidewalls (the first two sections of the conduit beneath the western sector of the Plaza) were lowered and stone slabs were again laid on top. This was done apparently at the time when the Plaza's floor was either replaced by a better one or its level was changed as a result of the above-mentioned

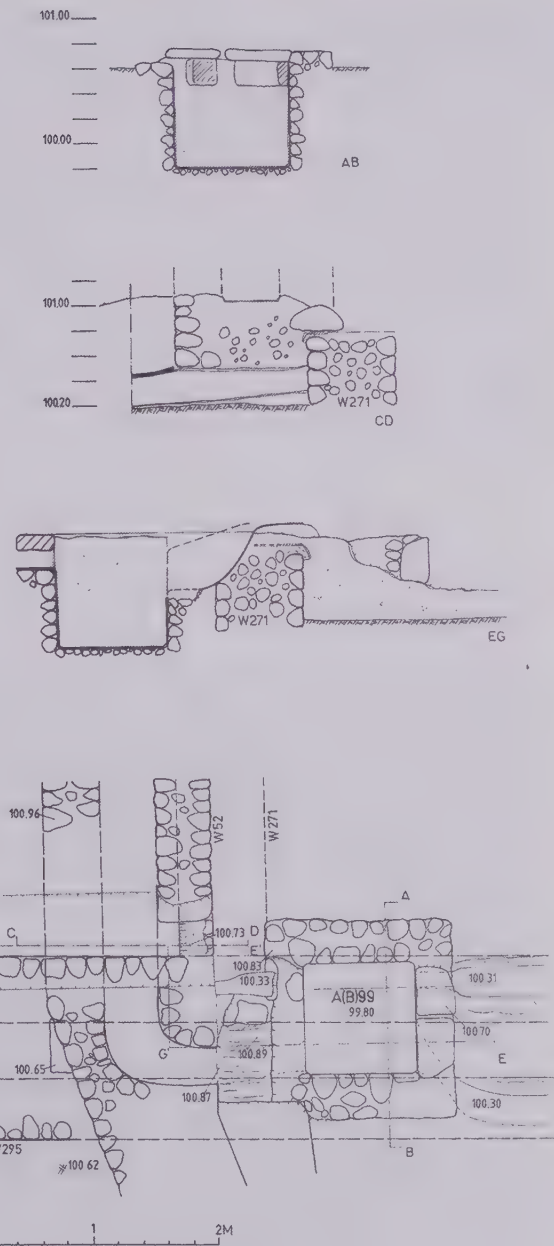
lowering operation. However, further to the east the 6.5-m-long section adjacent to the pools was left intact. Another change in the main channel, probably synchronous with the above-mentioned lowering of its sidewalls, is visible at its nearby turning point (toward the north). The right-angled corner was now given a rounded form (see Ill. 116). This minor change was probably introduced in order to improve the flow of the water in the conduit.

The addition of the minor channel, ending in the northern pool, basically solved the hydraulic problems caused by the planners' miscalculation of the water supply system to the swimming pools. The same system apparently continued to function in Stage 5 when the elevated section of the Na'aran Conduit was built inside the Western Garden and on top of the southern part of the Plaza's western sector (see below). At the point where Settling Tank A(B)99 was later built (in Stage 6), a double outlet channel was constructed, sloping down from the new elevated conduit (see Ill. 117). The main part of this outlet led water into the main conduit. The other, minor part (to the north) was connected to the channel that was attached to the northern sidewall of the same conduit. In both cases these outlets replaced the sections of the conduit and the latter channel that were demolished when the elevated conduit was constructed (see below).

The next and apparently last change in the supply system of the two swimming pools was implemented in Stage 6. This change, however, was the result of the



Ill. 116. Northern turn of the Na'aran Conduit, to the east of Settling Tank A(B)99, viewed from the north. Note the channel on each side of the conduit. [E.N.]



Ill. 117. Detailed plan and sections of Settling Tank A(B)99. Section AB: viewed from the west; section CD: viewed from the south and section EG: viewed from the north.

construction of the Grand Bypass and the elimination of the section of the Na'aran Conduit which passed through the Plaza. Settling Tank A(B)99 was built to the east of and attached to the "double outlet" discussed above (see Ills. 117). It was 90×90 cm in size, 90 cm deep and coated with ash-lime plaster. This tank was supplied with water via a hypothetical

channel, apparently passing through another settling tank [A(B)217] further to the west (see below).

Two channels issued from Settling Tank A(B)99 at the top of its eastern sidewall (see Ills. 118, 119 and 120). The southern one extended eastward in a fairly straight line, into the southern swimming pool. (At a point 4.2 m west of the pool it joined the above-described channel leading from the "mysterious" platform.) The northern channel was built on top of and into (practically replacing) the earlier channel which followed the northern sidewall of the original Na'aran Conduit, and had a similar function — supplying water to the northern swimming pool.¹¹ In any event, these two channels are preserved along almost their entire lengths.

This was apparently the last water system in the western sector of the Plaza dating to the Hasmonean period.¹² Unfortunately, we do not know exactly how



Ill. 118. Settling Tank A(B)99, with the two outlets of the channels in its eastern wall, viewed from the west. Note the plastered, beveled corner of the Plaza (center) and the remaining plaster of the conduit's northern sidewall. [E.N.]



Ill. 119. Overflow into Settling Tank A(B)99, viewed from the east. [E.N.]



Ill. 120. The two channels emerging from Settling tank A(B)99, viewed from the west.

the combined pool [A(B)101] was supplied with water in the Herodian period.

Later remains above the Plaza's floor

It seems that no building activity took place above the western and other sectors of the Plaza from the date of its construction up to the end of the Hasmonean

period (end of Stage 7). The picture here totally changed at the time of construction of Herod's Second Palace, and the combining of the two swimming pools to form a single, much larger one. The entire area west of the pool, and apparently all around it, was converted into a formal garden. In any event, the plaster floors were covered by a layer of soil, ca. 30 cm thick, as a bedding for the new garden.

The existence of this garden is mainly attested by two rows of flowerpots exposed to the west of the pool (in fact, west of the original northern one). The first row was 2.4 m away from the pool and the second one at twice that distance. The spaces between the pots in each row ranged from 1.0 m to 1.3 m. In a few cases two pots were located side by side (see Ill. 121). Another flowerpot was found on top of wall W239, on the southern continuation of the outer row mentioned above. Altogether, ca. 15 pots were exposed here *in situ*. Apparently, these two rows originally extended along the full length of the large pool. The only other evidence of *in situ* flowerpots around the pool was found in the area of the Eastern Garden. Many more such pots which probably once stood here apparently have disappeared with the erosion of the garden during the course of time. The holes dug into the ground for these pots penetrated slightly into the plastered floor of the Plaza. As known from

elsewhere in the Hellenistic-Roman world, specifically from Pompeii, these kinds of pots were always buried up to their necks in the soil of the garden.¹³ In some cases, such holes were the sole evidence of the former presence of these pots. In theory these flowerpots in the Western Garden, as well as the few in the Eastern Garden, may be dated to the time of Herod's Third Palace (see below). Nevertheless, there is no reason for not linking the construction of this formal garden, which surrounded the large pool, with the stage in which the two Hasmonean pools were combined by Herod, apparently during the construction of his Second Palace here. (In this case, the flowerpots might also have been added later.)

The relationship (with regard to levels) between the newly installed garden and the renovated pool, remains an open question. As explained above, the tops of the two pools' sidewalls were in fact at the same elevation as the plastered floor of the Plaza. The new level of the garden called for the raising of the large pool's sidewalls. There is, however, no trace of such additions. (Apparently, the bench also needed to be raised.) The only alternative to the raising of the pool's sidewalls was the construction of low retaining walls close to the pool on all sides, leaving a strip of the original plastered surface, perhaps 1 m wide, as a footpath. However, no remains of such hypothetical walls have survived.

The only other late elements in the discussed area [except for Winepress A(B)25-A(B)58 in the northwestern corner of the Plaza, which will be described together with the Western Garden] are two walls, W57 and W43, built at an angle and exposed in the southwestern corner of the Plaza. Both walls are 65 cm thick, with leveled tops, and built of small fieldstones. We assume that these two walls served as the base of a channel. In this case, they might have been connected with the Herodian channel exposed in the Western Garden (see below). Wall W43 continues to the east along the entire length of the southern side of the combined pool [A(B)101].

The eastern sector of the Plaza

The eastern sector of the Plaza (see Plan 14) was bounded on the west by the two pools, on the north by



Ill. 121. Herodian flowerpots exposed *in situ* to the west of the swimming pools, viewed from the north.

wall W257 (the southern wall of the Hasmonean Garden), on the east by walls W291 and W331, and on the south by the garden around the Pavilion. It might be assumed that the boundary between the Plaza and this garden, which is situated on a lower level, was aligned with wall W247 (the southern boundary of the Plaza's western sector).

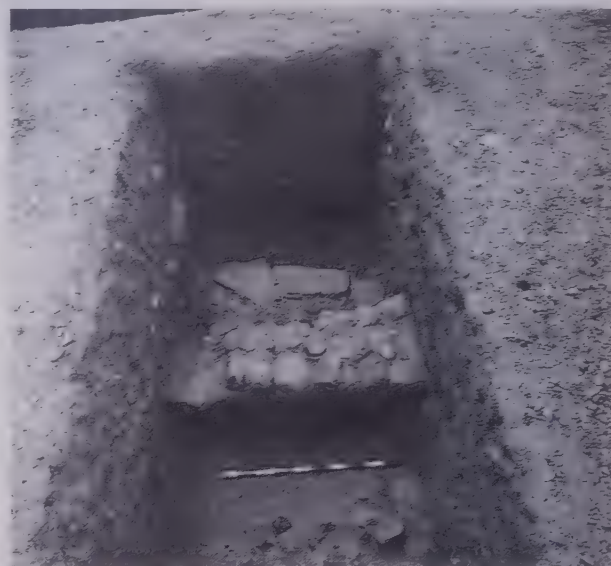
As a result of erosion, nothing remains of the original floor of the eastern sector, in contrast to the situation in the western sector. The surface here, prior to the excavations, was 0.65–1.2 m lower than that of the assumed floor which, to our mind, was at the same level and had the same surface (lime plaster on top of a stone bedding) as that of the western sector. However, it seems that here the Plaza sloped down slightly toward the east, as indicated by the gradually descending levels of the stone slabs in wall W298 (at its northern edge), from west to east

The only surviving element that relates directly to the Plaza (except for the fill, and the surrounding walls) was the east-west section of the Na'aran Conduit [designated as Locus A(B)220]. This section was exposed at the center of the Plaza, across its entire width. The conduit was, in fact, fully preserved here, aside from the original cover of stone slabs (see the western sector of the Plaza, above).

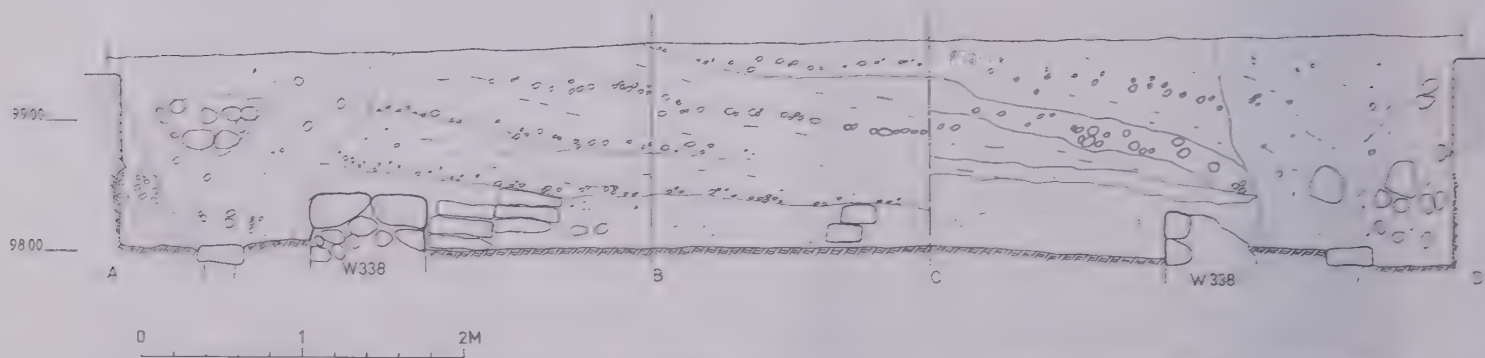
A few soundings at the center and on the boundaries of this sector enabled us to draw a partial picture of this area prior to the construction of the Pools Complex during Stage 3. (The earlier surface in its southern half was 1.0–1.2 m lower than the assumed level of the Plaza's floor and about 1.6–1.8 m lower in its northern half.)

Soundings at the center of the Plaza's eastern sector

Two walls in this area predate Stage 3, and apparently belong to the Buried Palace (Stage 2) or even to the Royal Estate (Stage 1). One short section of an east-west wall (W338) was revealed in Sounding A(B)207, close to and north of the section of the Na'aran Conduit [A(B)220] passing through the middle of the eastern sector (see Ill. 122). A few mud bricks were exposed on top of and next to the stone foundations of this wall (see Ill. 123). The second wall, W331, a north-south one, was revealed in a few soundings at the eastern edge of the sector in Loci A(B)201, A(B)202 and A(B)168. The latter wall



Ill. 123. Sounding A(B)207, with the stone foundation of mud-brick wall W338, viewed from the south.



Ill. 122. Sections through Sounding A(B)223 207. Section AB, viewed from the east; section BC, viewed from the south; section CD, viewed from the west. (For location sections, see Plan 14)

terminates in the south at an angle to east-west wall W332 (see Ill. 124), which ran parallel to and to the south of the Na'aran Conduit [Locus A(B)222]. In the north, as could be seen in Sounding A(B)202, wall W331 abutted the above-mentioned section of the conduit [A(B)220], as indicated by the abrupt break in the plaster which covered the latter's sidewall (see Ill. 125). Wall W331 continued under the conduit, thus predating it. However, once wall W309 was built (see below), most of wall W331 was looted and the gap was filled with material similar in composition to the general fill below the Plaza.

In theory wall W331 was originally connected to above-mentioned wall W338, exposed in Sounding A(B)207. Unfortunately, the tentative right-angled corner formed by these two walls was destroyed once the outlet channel from the combined Pool A(B)101 was constructed as part of Herod's Second Palace (see below).

In its final form, the Plaza was bounded on the east by two walls, very different in their features. Its northern section was bordered by wall W291, 1.5 m thick, and the southern one by wall W309, 0.85 m thick. However, whereas the first wall was built as a revetment, the second one was a regular wall, erected partly on top of the sidewall of the Na'aran Conduit and partly on top of the fill behind it. (It



Ill. 125. Sounding A(B)202, with the abrupt break in the plaster of the conduit's sidewall where wall W331 abutted it, viewed from the south.

seems that the function of the earlier wall, W331, as a retaining wall for the Plaza, was now transferred to the conduit.) In any event, we assume that these walls were merely terrace walls, facing the lower-lying Eastern Garden, and not freestanding ones. This assumption is based on the symmetry with the Western Garden, bounded on its east by terrace wall W279.¹⁴

The northern fringe of the Plaza

We shall discuss here the narrow strip, 3.5 m wide, which was left between the northern swimming pool and wall W257, the southern boundary wall of the Hasmonean Garden. (In fact we are dealing with the strip left here between the Plaza's western and eastern sectors.) Whereas at the northern edge of the western sector most of the original floor, at least its stone bedding, was preserved intact, nothing remained of the floor of this narrow strip to the north of the pool. In fact, the only remnant worthy of note here was a narrow north-south channel, apparently an outlet from the northern swimming pool, leading toward the Hasmonean Garden.

However, important data were obtained from the analysis of wall W257 and wall W298 which was built on top of it. Wall W257, 1.2 m thick, which was part of the original Hasmonean Garden, is identical in its width and structure to the garden's other three boundary walls. These were probably the foundations of mud-brick walls which have



Ill. 124. The southwestern corner of the Eastern Garden, formed by walls W331 and W332.

disappeared. It seems that later, apparently in Stage 5, wall W257 was demolished in order to be replaced by a colonnade. The upper wall W298 is only 70 cm thick and built in a much cruder manner than the lower one. The outstanding features of the upper wall are stone slabs integrated into it at regular intervals of ca. 2.2 m. In some places these slabs are missing but gaps in the wall mark the locations from which they were looted. The slabs indicate the locations of the columns which have since disappeared.

It is significant that the western end of the upper wall turns slightly toward the south in the last 3 m. This was apparently a result of the location of Hall A(B)131 on the northern side of the Western Garden (see below). This is in fact our main argument in dating the above change (the replacement of wall W257 by a colonnade) to Stage 5.

THE PAVILION [A(B)103], including the surrounding garden

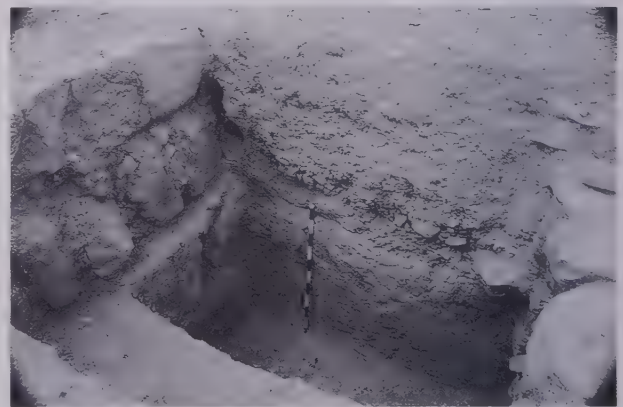
The exposure of the Pavilion south of the two swimming pools [A(B)101] commenced in the first season, as the remains of walls forming a rectangle were clearly visible above the ground surface. (These walls were also noticed and surveyed by Kelso and Baramki, as mentioned above.) Most of the remains here proved to belong to one striking structure, ca. 21×17 m in size, being the foundations of a building which was situated directly to the south of the two swimming pools A(B)101. This building, designated as A(B)103, which we have named the "Pavilion," included the following loci: A(B)4, A(B)5, A(B)6, A(B)15, A(B)16, A(B)28, A(B)421, and A(B)422.

This rectangular structure [A(B)103], of which only the foundations have actually survived, is comprised of two concentric rectangles (see Plan 16). The outer one, 21.3 m long and 17.1 m wide, has walls 1.7–2.0 m thick (1.7 m on the north, 1.8 m on the west and 2.0 m on the south and east.) The inner structure is 13.8 m long and 9.8 m wide. Its walls are 1.2–1.3 m thick (1.2 m on the north and south and 1.3 m on the east and west). These two rectangles were linked together in the following manner: the northern wall W9 of the inner structure continues on

both sides, up to the western wall W8 and the eastern wall W6 of the outer structure; on the other hand, the western (W12) and eastern (W10) walls of the inner structure continue on their southern sides up to the southern wall W7 of the outer structure. It is noteworthy that whereas the two basic rectangles were built with essentially straight walls, most of the four "connecting" walls are uneven, their width changing from side to side. In any event, we have no doubt that these asymmetrical links between the two rectangles must have been merely substructural with no walls above them (sort of "blind walls").

All these foundation walls (as well as wall W44; see below) were built of large fieldstones set in mortar.¹⁵ The stones were laid in courses and leveled with small stones and mud mortar. Most of these walls have been preserved to the level of +101.15, apparently their original height. At that level, traces of lime mortar bearing the imprints of ashlar were noted on part of the inner rectangle's southern wall W11.

This structure, no doubt, was built in order to create an elevated platform. Its top was 1.0–1.3 m higher than the original ground surface [as we learnt from Sounding A(B)5] and ca. 1.5 m higher than the two swimming pools. The discussed foundation walls were built in trenches ca. 1 m deep, thus having an overall height of ca. 2.2–2.5 m. Their construction was followed by the dumping of fill to an average height of 1.3 m. The lower part of wall W9 [as seen in Sounding A(B)5] was 10 cm wider than its upper part (see Ill. 126). It seems that the Pavilion itself was built of ashlar, later looted. Unfortunately, no floors



Ill. 126. Sounding A(B)5 in Pavilion A(B)103, viewed from the east.

of this building have survived. Their elevation, though, was probably slightly higher than the top of the foundation walls — at ca. +101.40.

Two primary structures were attached to the above-mentioned platform: one on the north, along almost its entire length, and the other (in fact only one wall) on the south. The structure on the north was virtually a secondary platform, bounded on the west and east by low retaining walls (the western one being 25 cm to the east of the main platform's western boundary and the eastern one 50 cm to the west of its eastern boundary). The northern boundary of this secondary platform is largely missing; however, its two corners have survived intact. There are no direct clues as to the original function of this secondary platform. Nevertheless, architectural considerations indicate that it might well have been the base of a broad flight of stairs (22.5 m in length) which connected the two swimming pools and the surrounding Plaza with the missing building. To the east of the Pavilion we exposed an isolated section of a channel, the function of which is unclear to us.

To the south, wall W44 (2.10 m thick, preserved for a length of 4.50 m) was built at right angles to wall W7, the southern wall of the primary platform. This wall, also built of large fieldstones set in mortar, apparently belongs to the original building phase. Hypothetically, a second symmetrical wall might have existed here, 2.5 m to the east. These two tentative walls may have served as a foundation for another flight of steps (5.0 m wide) leading from the south into the Pavilion.

Remains to the west of the Pavilion

A few structures were exposed immediately to the west of the Pavilion: two water installations [Pools A(B)399 and A(B)252] and a small structure [A(B)227] situated close to its northwestern corner (see Plan 16).

Pool A(B)399 (4.0 m long and 3.4 m wide): The pool's floor was never reached during the excavations owing to the piled-up debris which will be described below. For the same reason, only the upper part of a flight of stairs, altogether six steps (80 cm wide and



Ill. 127. Debris of architectural fragments exposed in Pool A(B)399, viewed from the west.

built along the pool's western wall), has been revealed.

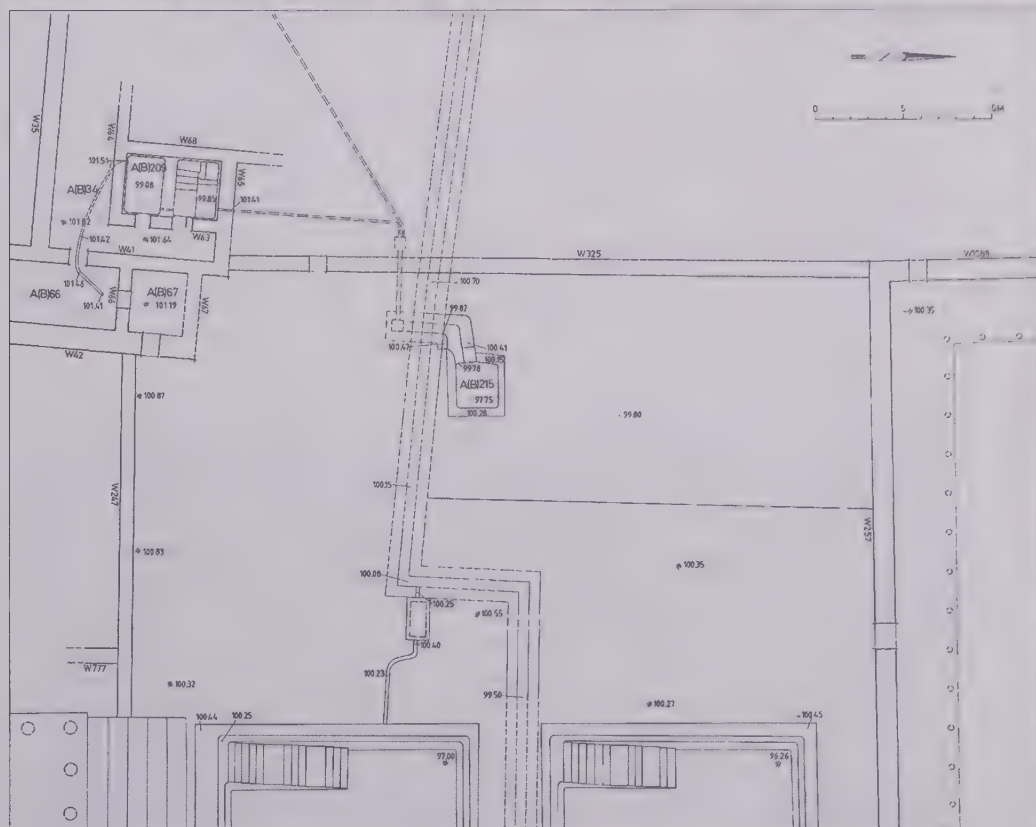
The whole pool, up to ca. 50 cm below its preserved top, was filled with massive debris of carved stones, most of which originated from Doric columns and an entablature (see Ill. 127). A significant group of three column drums was exposed close and parallel to the flight of stairs (in the pool's northwestern corner). No doubt, this group, like the other fallen stones, had toppled as a result of a sudden catastrophe — apparently an earthquake. Among the other masonry were two Doric capitals and many stones which had formed the entablature — some including triglyphs and metopes (see Ill. 128).



Ill. 128. Stones with triglyphs and metopes, exposed in Pool A(B)399.

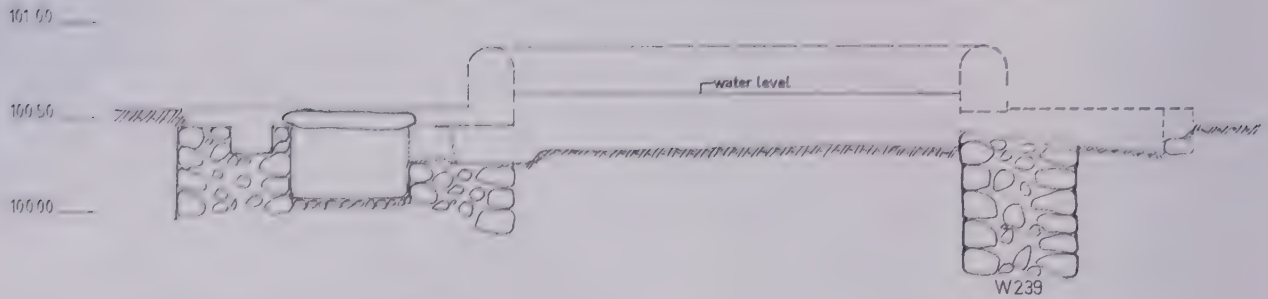


III. 130. The Hasmonean Bathhouse, with the swimming pools in the background, viewed from the west.



Plan 17. Partly reconstructed plan of the Western Garden and its surroundings in Area AB in Stage 3.

HASMONEAN AND HERODIAN PALACES AT JERICHO



Ill. 131. Platform viewed from the north. [E.N.]

the garden included the Na'aran Conduit in its original course which flanked the garden on its southern side and continued eastward, passing through the Plaza between the two swimming pools [A(B)101], through the section which was later dismantled in the days of Herod. The Pools A(B)101 themselves were fed by a special installation (the "platform," see above) located to the west of the southern pool (see Ill. 131, and for a schematic reconstruction of this installation, see Ill. 132). At this stage, the southern pool obtained its water directly from this installation, whereas the northern one was probably supplied with water by means of a hypothetical channel linking the two pools.

Another water installation, Septic Tank A(B)215, which existed in this stage, was located at the southern end of the garden. In our view, the purpose of this installation was to drain water from Ritual Bath A(B)209-A(B)243 of the Buried Palace and probably also from the latter's other bathing facilities. The construction of the Pools Complex actually blocked any outflow of drainage water from these facilities, such water having previously been used evidently for the irrigation of gardens to the east of the palace. The drainage water now was led into

the Western Garden by means of a channel that passed under the Na'aran Conduit. Most of this drainage channel is missing (evidently having been dismantled during the construction of the moat in Stage 4, when the relevant section of the Na'aran Conduit was dismantled), but its L-shaped end, immediately to the north of the Na'aran Conduit's original course, has been fully preserved.

It seems that this initial drainage system did not function optimally and the water arriving from the palace was not fully absorbed by the soil of the garden. We assume that in order to solve this problem, Septic Tank A(B)215 was built adjacent to the channel's outlet. This pit measured 2.5×2.4 m and was 2.4 m deep. Its walls were built like those of a pool but were not plastered (aside from the section below the channel's outlet). The bottom of the pit was also unplastered. This pit was intentionally filled with small fieldstones, which made possible the seepage of the water into the ground. A solution of this type to the problem of waste-liquid absorption is conventional up to the present day in localities lacking comprehensive sewage systems, e.g., in Jerusalem almost up to the first half of the 20th century.



Ill. 132. Section through the Na'aran Conduit and the schematically reconstructed 'platform,' viewed from the south. (For location section, see Plan 15)

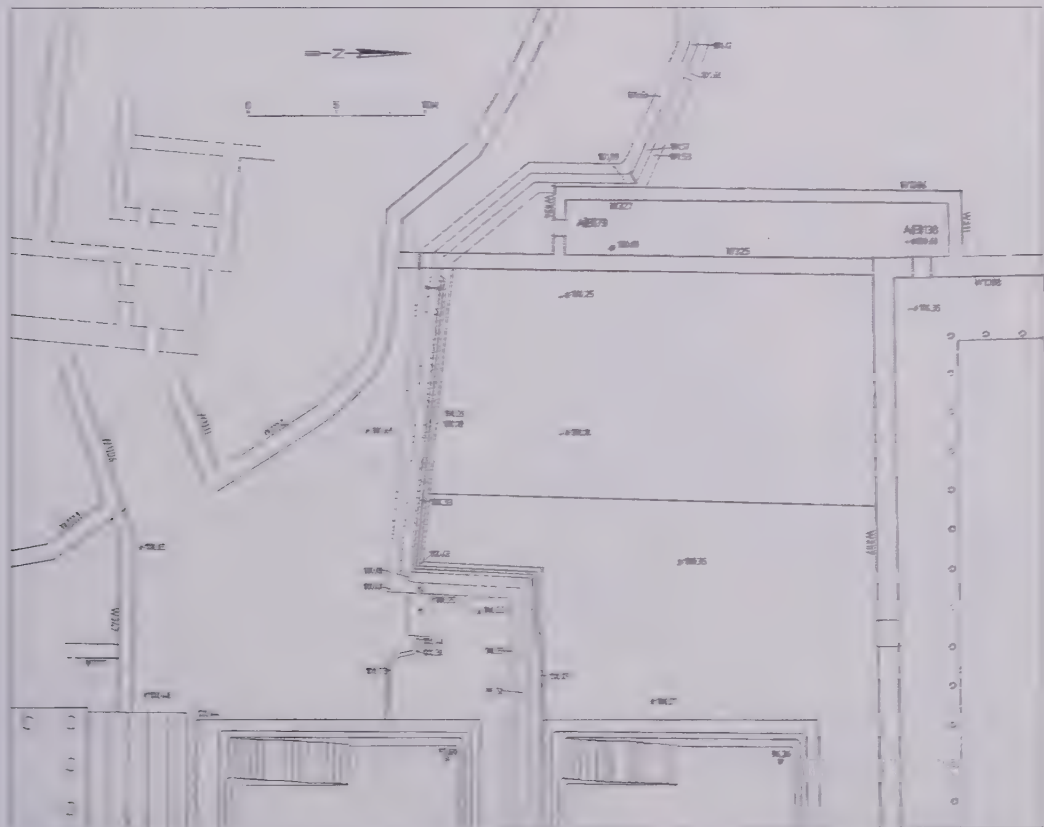
Stage 4 (see Plan 18): In this stage, during which the first Hasmonean palace was buried and the Fortified Palace, surrounded by a moat, was built, very few changes were made in the layout of the Western Garden. The only one of significance was the disuse of above-described Septic Tank A(B)215. Following the construction of the moat, all sewage from the new, elevated building was evidently drained toward the south, to Wadi Shaqq ad-Dabi.

Following the construction of the moat, changes were introduced in the vicinity of the Western Garden. One of them took place to the south of the garden, in the western extension of the Plaza's western sector [A(B)30] which was truncated, and the moat's outer wall was built at its margin. The second change was to the west of the garden, in the Na'aran Conduit. The section which was dismantled when the moat was built was now replaced by the Small Bypass (starting in Area AC; see above) which probably ended close to the southwestern corner of this garden. It is of importance to mention here that

the planners of the moat took great care not to damage the garden itself, thus necessitating an irregular change in the alignment of the moat.

It seems that during this stage a long narrow hall (3.2 m wide and 21.5 m long), which apparently served as a sort of a corridor, was built adjacent to the Western Garden, to its west. This corridor probably served as a passageway into the Hasmonean Garden, obviating the need to pass through the Plaza which surrounded the two large swimming pools. In any event, the last section of the Small Bypass was adapted to the corridor's western wall (W327-W1086). The corridor was probably entered on the south (through an opening in wall W324), and offered access to the Hasmonean Garden through an opening which was breached in the corridor's northeastern corner.

A tentative change was now made in the water supply system to the pair of swimming pools [A(B)101]. Apparently a channel on top of the northern sidewall of the Na'aran Conduit was built at



Plan 18. Partly reconstructed plan of the Western Garden and its surroundings in Area AB in Stage 4.

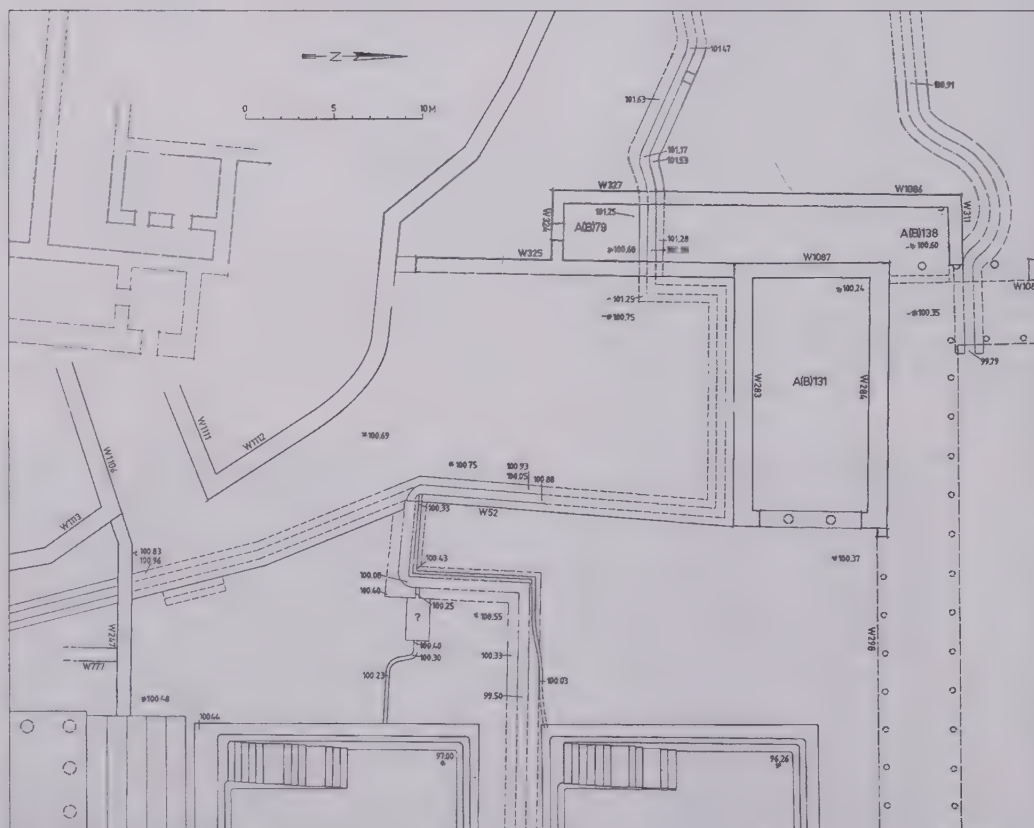
this time. This channel supplied water to the northern pool. We assume that it branched off from the conduit close to the garden's southwestern corner, with the aid of an installation (see Ill. 115).

Stage 5 (see Plan 19): In this stage began the appropriation of the portions of the garden which from now on became a potential building site. In the northern part of the garden, rectangular Structure A(B)131 was erected, which might have served as a garden *triclinium*. The rest of the area, toward the south, continued to serve its original purpose and apparently was even slightly extended to the south and also raised (see below). Construction in the garden's northern part was linked with simultaneous changes made on the northern side of the Pools Complex: replacement of the wall separating the Plaza from the Hasmonean Garden by a colonnade. This change gave the new garden *triclinium* its special character. From here it was possible to view not only the swimming pools but also the peristyle

garden (the Hasmonean Garden) which existed to the north. (In analogy to changes in the Western Garden during this stage, the Eastern Garden was "sacrificed" and a unit of three storerooms was built on it.)

A significant change, probably linked with the construction of the Twin Palaces, now also took place in the water system of the area under discussion. The course of the Na'aran Conduit, in the section close to the Western Garden, was altered as the result of the desire to lead another offshoot from it toward the south, to the Twin Palaces. The new offshoot passed at a higher level between the Fortified Palace and the Pavilion. A logical alternative would have been to lead it below ground level rather than elevating it, but for some unknown reason this was not done.

In order not to harm the garden itself, the conduit's new course, of smaller width (only 1.35 m), was apparently built along the garden's western, northern and eastern edges.²⁰ Most of this new section fringing the area of the garden was later



Plan 19. Partly reconstructed plan of the Western Garden and its surroundings in Area AB in Stage 5.

dismantled (in Stage 6), but its last portion (W52), 7.5 m long, has survived *in situ*. At the end of this section the conduit again links up with the original one but at an elevation some 70 cm higher. Here was located the bifurcation point: on one side a small “waterfall” was installed (see Ill. 117), which conveyed water from the new elevated conduit into the original one (from this point onward it flowed beneath the floor of the Plaza); on the other side another new section (the “offshoot”) was built, which led water in the direction of the Twin Palaces. Most of the last-mentioned section was later looted or eroded but there is clear evidence of its existence on the southern edge of the Plaza, next to wall W247.

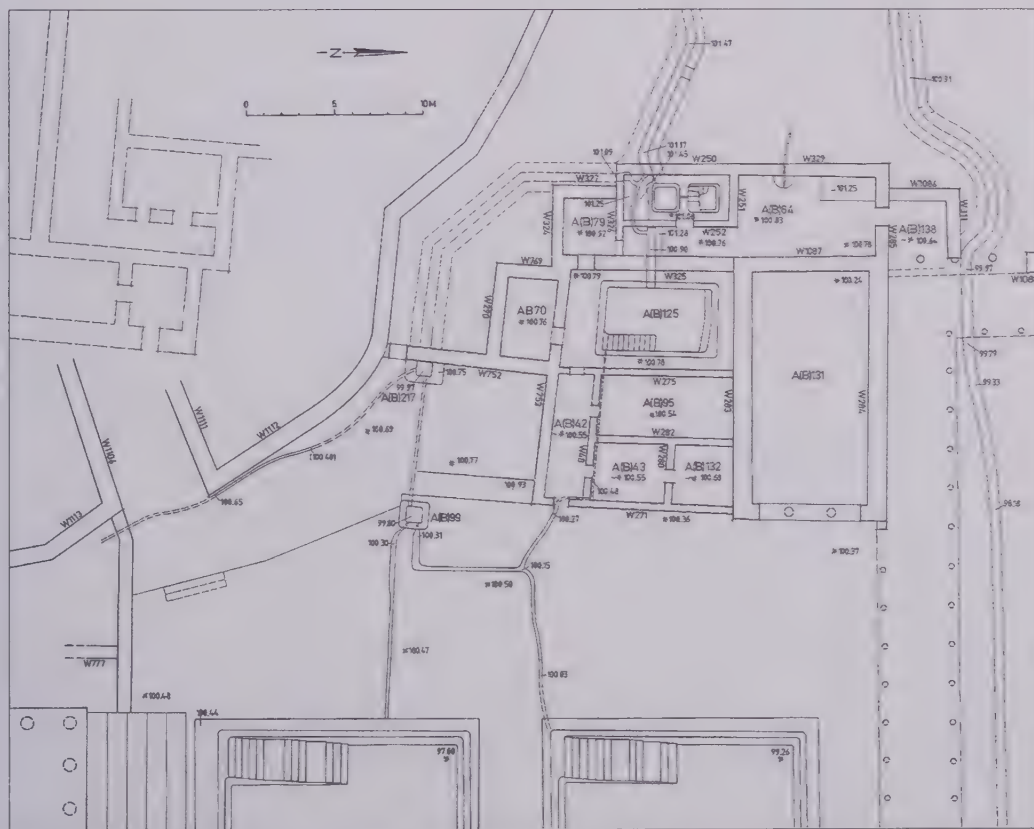
Following the construction of the latter section (leading to the Twin Palaces), a strip of the Plaza adjacent to the wall surrounding the moat was left isolated from the rest of the Plaza. It is possible that this strip was now filled with earth and became an integral part of the reduced Western Garden.

It seems that the construction of the Grand Bypass

was started during this stage. In our view, the section between the main conduit (at a point to the west of Area AC) and the southwestern corner of the Hasmonean Garden was built at this time. There are several possible reasons for this timing of the bypass:

1. There was a need for more water in the area of the garden, as the changes in the architectural layout were accompanied by horticultural changes;
2. The Grand Bypass in its entirety was already planned at this stage but only partly executed;
3. The original supply of water to the Hasmonean Garden passed through the Western Garden but its hypothetical course was blocked by the construction of the new garden *triclinium* [A(B)131].

Stage 6 (see Plan 20): During this stage, the Western Garden actually ceased to exist. Intensive building operations were carried out in its area and determined the actual layout of the Bathhouse Complex (see Ill. 133).



Plan 20. Partly reconstructed plan of the Western Garden and its surroundings in Area AB in Stage 6.

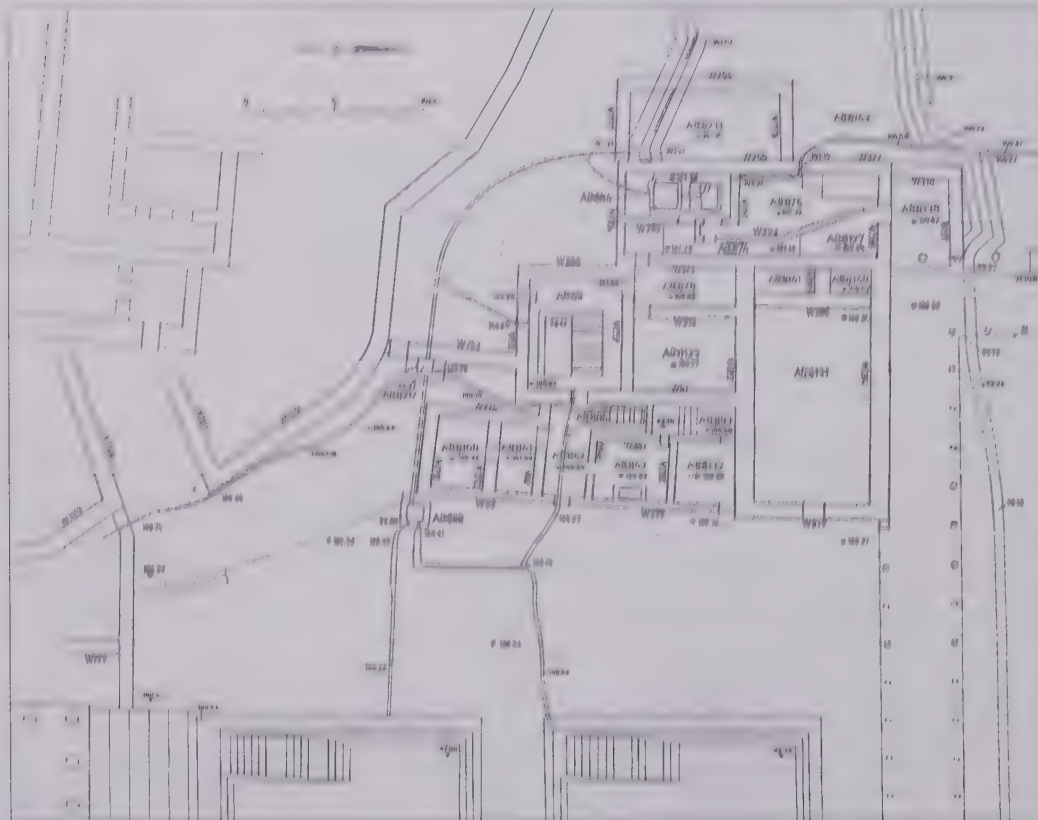


III. 133 The Hasmonaean Bathhouse viewed from the north

At the same time, the main central part of the long narrow hall [A(B)79-A(B)138] built in Stage 4 to the west of the garden was extended to the west and converted into a ritual bath [A(B)64]. This installation was flanked on the north and south by two small rooms, erected at the two ends of the former long hall. To the east of the ritual bath and to

the south of the garden triclinium [A(B)131], various rooms were built, the central element of which was Pool A(B)125. The actual size of some of the rooms is in doubt, as they were overbuilt in Stage 7.

Significant changes were made in the general water supply system during this stage. The main supply of water to the east ceased to pass through the Plaza (including the strip between the two swimming pools), and was now replaced by the Grand Bypass which had just been completed. The elevated conduit built around the garden in Stage 5 was dismantled (aside from the above-mentioned 7.5-m-long section), evidently to take advantage of the gained area and to make use of the masonry. [However, a small section of the elevated conduit, immediately to the west of Pool A(B)125, continued to be used.] Further to the west, the northern sidewall of the conduit was dismantled in order to build the southern pool of the ritual bath. Here, a small local bypass was built, diverting water into Pool A(B)125 via the above-mentioned remaining section of the conduit. Another small channel branching off from the local



Plan 21. Partly reconstructed plan of the Western Garden and its surroundings in Area AB in Stage 7.

Worthy of note is the fact that apparently during the same stage, two additional pools were added slightly to the south, between the moat wall and the Pavilion [A(B)103], and another small pool was constructed in the strip west of the storerooms. All of these three pools apparently were used as ritual baths.

The relocation of the pools in the Hasmonean Bathhouse necessitated the adaptation of the water system. The Small Bypass of the Naʿaran Conduit was now completely blocked west of the ritual bath [A(B)64]. A new southern branch, west of the blockage, apparently fed the various pools. At the same time, apparently as a result of the raising of the ritual bath's floors, it was provided with a new drainage system. The drains from pools A(B)9 and A(B)86 probably linked up with the already existing drain from Pool A(B)125, leading the water to the northern swimming pool.

The Herodian Period (see Plan 22): As a result of the destruction apparently caused by an earthquake in 31 B.C.E., none of the above-described structures existed during Herod's day. Only the two large swimming pools [A(B)101] continued to function, though from now on as a single huge pool. The Plaza ceased to exist and was instead covered by a formal garden. With the Herodian period we also associate the large winepress [A(B)58] exposed mainly above Hall A(B)131. Also belonging to this period is a small channel, built to the west of the winepress, on top of the bathhouse's ruins, as well as its tentative continuation (on top of walls W57 and W43; see above).

As the reader is by now familiar with the basic layout of the complex area of the Western Garden (mainly from the stratigraphic point of view, we shall now turn to its detailed description. The reader should refer here to two sets of plans, one schematic (Plans 17–22) and the other the detailed (Plans 15 and 23). Plan 15 features Stage 3–6 and Plan 23 Stage 7 as well as the Herodian period. The descriptions are presented in the following order:

- The Hasmonean Bathhouse;
- Earlier remains below the Hasmonean Bathhouse;
- Remains south of the Hasmonean Bathhouse;
- Remains west of the Hasmonean Bathhouse [in particular Ritual Bath A(B)64];

- Remains north of the Hasmonean Bathhouse [including Herodian Winepress A(B)25-A(B)58].

The Hasmonean Bathhouse

The Hasmonean Bathhouse in Stage 7 occupied virtually all of the area of the Western Garden except for Hall A(B)131 (built in Stage 5). It seems that all the bathhouse walls were built of mud bricks laid on top of a fieldstone foundation (containing many wadi pebbles). Almost all the bricks have disappeared. Most of the stone foundations rose to a height of 40 cm above the floors and were exposed just below ground level.

Rooms A(B)100 and A(B)41

Two adjacent rooms, built along the southern section of the elevated Naʿaran Conduit (dating from Stage 5 and designated as W52 during the excavations). No trace of the eastern wall of these two rooms has remained. We assume that the missing wall must have been located on top of a remnant (W52, 135 cm thick) of the conduit's lower part. The width of this wall was apparently 45 cm, equal to that of the conduit's sidewall and similar to that of W294, the western wall of these two rooms. The other walls of both rooms were of greater thickness: 80 cm in W293 and W292, 70 cm in W49. The floors of both rooms were found slightly below the remains of the abandoned conduit. This might be the result of subsidence and originally they could have risen slightly above the conduit, practically covering it.

Room A(B)100 (length 3.0 m, width 2.9 m): No sign of doorways was found in this room. Theoretically, in view of the poor state of preservation, they may have existed on the northern, western and southern sides (but not on the eastern one, due to the difference in levels). According to general considerations, both the southern and northern walls appear to be likely locations for doorways. The room had a white lime plaster floor laid on a bedding of wadi pebbles on top of beaten earth.

Room A(B)41 (length 3.0 m, width 2.0 m): Only one definite doorway was exposed in this room, in its northern wall W49. Only the western jamb, built of

new wall (W299), 1.7 m thick, constructed partially of ashlars. Wall W299 seems to stop abruptly in a straight line 7.30 m south of wall W257, the southern boundary wall of the Hasmonean Garden. It is not clear if this was indeed its southern end.

We have no clue as to the function of this broad wall. Also lacking is a clear picture of the relationship between wall W299 and the small stepped pool [A(B)63] exposed at the northern extremity of this strip. (This pool was probably used as a ritual bath.) Pool A(B)63 may have been built at the same time as the broad wall, though perhaps also later.

Pool A(B)63 is 1.8 m long and 1.4 m wide. Its assumed depth is 1.4 m. A narrow flight of steps runs along its eastern sidewall. The pool was coated with ash-lime plaster. At its bottom were found roughly a dozen intact vessels — a storage jar, a cooking pot and plates (see Ill. 180). The room in which this pool was located (being isolated at the northern end of the strip under discussion) was probably bounded on the south by wall W333, 6 m south of the pool. (Only one course of this wall has survived.) In any event, nothing is left of the pool's rims as well as of the floor around it, which is totally eroded.

In this western strip, as in all three storerooms, the material that had accumulated between the original floor and the surface prior to excavation consisted mainly of fragmentized mud bricks. (As mentioned above, a few courses of intact mud bricks were found on top of the stone base of wall W303, the eastern wall of this strip.) If one assumes that this rubble of mud bricks may have resulted from the earthquake that apparently destroyed the Fortified Palace (and other parts of the Hasmonean complex), the fact that the intact vessels found both in the ash layers on the south of the strip and in Pool A(B)63 belong to the Hasmonean repertoire creates a local stratigraphic problem. However, this debris might have been a result of local changes connected with the construction of wall W299 and the ritual bath.

Storeroom A(B)171 (length 31.6 m, width 2.8 m; see Plan 14)

Most of Storeroom A(B)171 was exposed. It consisted, from south to north, of Loci A(B)233, A(B)238, A(B)171, A(B)184, A(B)172, and A(B)216.

The only exposed doorway leading into this storeroom is in its eastern wall W304, but hypothetically the long room could have been entered via a doorway in its short southern wall, although no signs of steps were found here.

The original floor of this storeroom (at about +97.80) was exposed only in its central part [Loci A(B)171 and A(B)184], and in the north [Locus A(B)172]. In the northern part the floor was of beaten earth but the central part was roughly paved with small fieldstones. In Sounding A(B)216 dug at the northern end of the room, the brown soil found below the floor was the same as that in Sounding A(B)206 beneath the above-mentioned western strip. The foundations of the room's southern, eastern and western walls here started ca. 20 cm below the floor, whereas that of the northern wall W257 commenced 60 cm below this level.³¹

Evidence of later floors was found only in the southern part of Storeroom A(B)171 [Loci A(B)233; A(B)238 and A(B)241]. Here ash layers were revealed at +98.30-+98.40, ca. 50 cm above the assumed original floor level. (This is indirect support for the assumption that the room was probably entered from the south.) A group of stones associated with these ash layers, found adjacent to the southern wall, was probably part of an installation.

Two important finds in this room relate to a much later phase, when the entire storeroom complex was totally covered by debris. One is a section of the Herodian channel which led water from the combined pool [A(B)101] to the fields to the east. The second find — two flowerpots — is also to be dated to the Herodian period. They were uncovered 1.0 m above the room's floor — one complete pot about 12.5 m from the room's southern end, and parts of another a few meters to the north.

The finds on top of the original floor were scanty.

Storeroom A(B)240 (length 31.8 m, width 2.8 m; see Plan 14)

More than half of this storeroom was exposed (see Ill. 178). It had two doorways, close to its center, one opposite the other, leading into the two adjacent storerooms. Hypothetically, this long room could have been entered via a doorway in its short southern wall, although, as in Storeroom A(B)171, no direct

signs of steps were found here. The original floor, of beaten earth, was exposed in the central part of this room, at +97.75. A higher, apparently later floor was exposed at +98.05 in its southern part, together with a group of large ashlar. These could either be part of an installation or, alternatively, of a stairway (see Ill. 182). Also related to the higher floor was a column drum exposed east of this group.



Ill. 182. Southern end of Storeroom A(B)240, with the group of large ashlar and a column drum, both related to the higher floor, viewed from the west.

A small sounding [A(B)200] in the northwestern corner penetrated below the floor. The data obtained relate mainly to wall W257 (the southern wall of the Hasmonean Garden) which becomes narrower here, although the width of its foundation is equal to that elsewhere.

The finds in this storeroom were sparse.

Storeroom A(B)236 (length 32.0 m, width 2.8 m; see Plan 14)

Most of this storeroom was exposed. It consisted, from south to north, of the following loci: A(B)236, A(B)169, A(B)181 and A(B)165. The only exposed doorway is in the western wall W305 and leads into Storeroom A(B)240. Hypothetically, the long room could have been entered via a doorway in its short

southern wall, although, as in Storerooms A(B)171 and A(B)240, no direct signs of steps were found here.

The storeroom has a beaten-earth floor at +97.65; however, a narrow but uneven strip of fieldstone paving (including some ashlar in secondary use) was exposed along most of its center (see Ill. 183). This strip, ca. 1.0 m wide, may indicate the use of this room for the storage of liquids. A higher floor was revealed at the southern end of the room, ca. 50 cm above the original one, a phenomenon similar to that noted in the other two storerooms.

The finds in this storeroom were meager.

The Southern Strip

The southern strip is a narrow area bounded on the south by wall W332, on the west by wall W331, and on the north by the three storerooms. It consists of Loci A(B)222 (the east-west section of the Na'aran Conduit), A(B)235, A(B)237, and A(B)239. This strip lacked an eastern boundary and merges with the open area to the east.

The section of the Na'aran Conduit included here [designated as Locus A(B)222, as mentioned above] is among the best preserved ones. The good preservation here was due to the fact that when the



Ill. 183. Strip of fieldstone paving in the north of Storeroom A(B)236, viewed from the west. Note Installation A(B)59/1 in the background.

Grand Bypass was built, this section was abandoned and apparently covered deliberately with soil.

A group of stone slabs laid on top of the conduit (together with a row of ashlar laid on the channel's sidewall, opposite the western strip) probably served as a bridge leading into this southern strip (see Ill. 124). A few meters to the east, opposite Storeroom A(B)171, a narrow channel extending from the south was exposed. The water flowing in it was drained into the Na'aran Conduit.

Southeast of the southern strip [in Locus A(B)239] we exposed the point at which the Grand Bypass linked up with the original Na'aran Conduit (see Ill. 184). Evidence of another secondary channel was found at exactly this point,³² this time receiving water from the Na'aran Conduit and extending southward. This secondary channel (Stage 3 or 4) continued to function after the original section of the Na'aran Conduit [A(B)222] went out of use (Stage 7), now being supplied with water from the Grand Bypass. However, in the Herodian period, this connection was apparently blocked, and the water in the Grand Bypass was directed solely eastward into the remaining part of the Na'aran Conduit. In any event, wall W332, which bounds the southern strip on the south, is broken here, probably as the result of repairs to this secondary channel which had been in use for a long time (see also Areas AE, AG and AL).



Ill. 184. Locus A(B)239, with the linkup of the Grand Bypass with the Na'aran Conduit, viewed from the north.

Area East of the Eastern Garden

The area to the east of the Eastern Garden (in fact part of the Royal Estate's territory) is bounded on the south by wall W332 and an east-west section of the Na'aran Conduit, on the west by wall W306 and a north-south section of the Grand Bypass (see Ill. 185), and on the north and east by the boundaries of the excavation. The area consists of Loci A(B)272, A(B)166, A(B)188, A(B)175, A(B)173 and A(B)59/1. The last three loci (probably an industrial installation) will be described separately.



Ill. 185. Section of the Grand Bypass east of Storeroom A(B)236, joining the Na'aran Conduit at the southeastern corner of the room, viewed from the south.

The excavation of Loci A(B)272 and A(B)166 has revealed not only parts of the above-mentioned section of the Grand Bypass, but also areas which probably served at times as a garbage pit (see Ill. 185). Large quantities of pottery sherds were found here, mainly at levels lower than the conduit, and therefore also beneath it, dating the pit to earlier than